



LET'S PLAY WITH CODEIGNITER

Part—1

Here's a basic introduction to CodeIgniter, an open source Web framework that helps to quickly develop dynamic websites with PHP.

To get started, you need to install the framework (I assume you already have a working Web and database server set up). Download the zip file from codeigniter.com/downloads/; extract it, and move the folder to your Web server's DocumentRoot (usually `/var/www/`). While moving it, I renamed the extracted codeigniter folder to 'ci2' to save on typing. Now, in a browser, visit '`localhost/ci2/`'. If you see something like what's shown in Figure 1, CodeIgniter has been successfully installed.

The page has a user guide link for help, if you need it. CodeIgniter also has a very huge and supportive online forum community—visit codeigniter.com/forums/.

MVC

CodeIgniter follows the MVC (*Model-View-Controller*) software architecture for development. *View* and *Controller* are necessary, while *Model* is optional. MVC's greatest strength lies in the fact that it divides the

application. If you need to change database queries, you don't touch other files, and vice-versa. Listed below are the files that MVC is made up of:

- **Model:** All database-related work is done through the model file.
- **View:** The front-end view (here, HTML) design is contained in the view file.
- **Controller:** The *Controller*, the base of MVC, controls everything inside the application. You can use *Views* and *Models* only through a *Controller*; without a *Controller* file, your CodeIgniter app will not run.

The *application* sub-folder is your main folder, so let that be your main focus.

Configuration

To avoid run-time errors, you need to do some CodeIgniter configuration changes in three files—*autoload.php*, *config.php* and *database.php* in the *config* sub-folder. As per the